

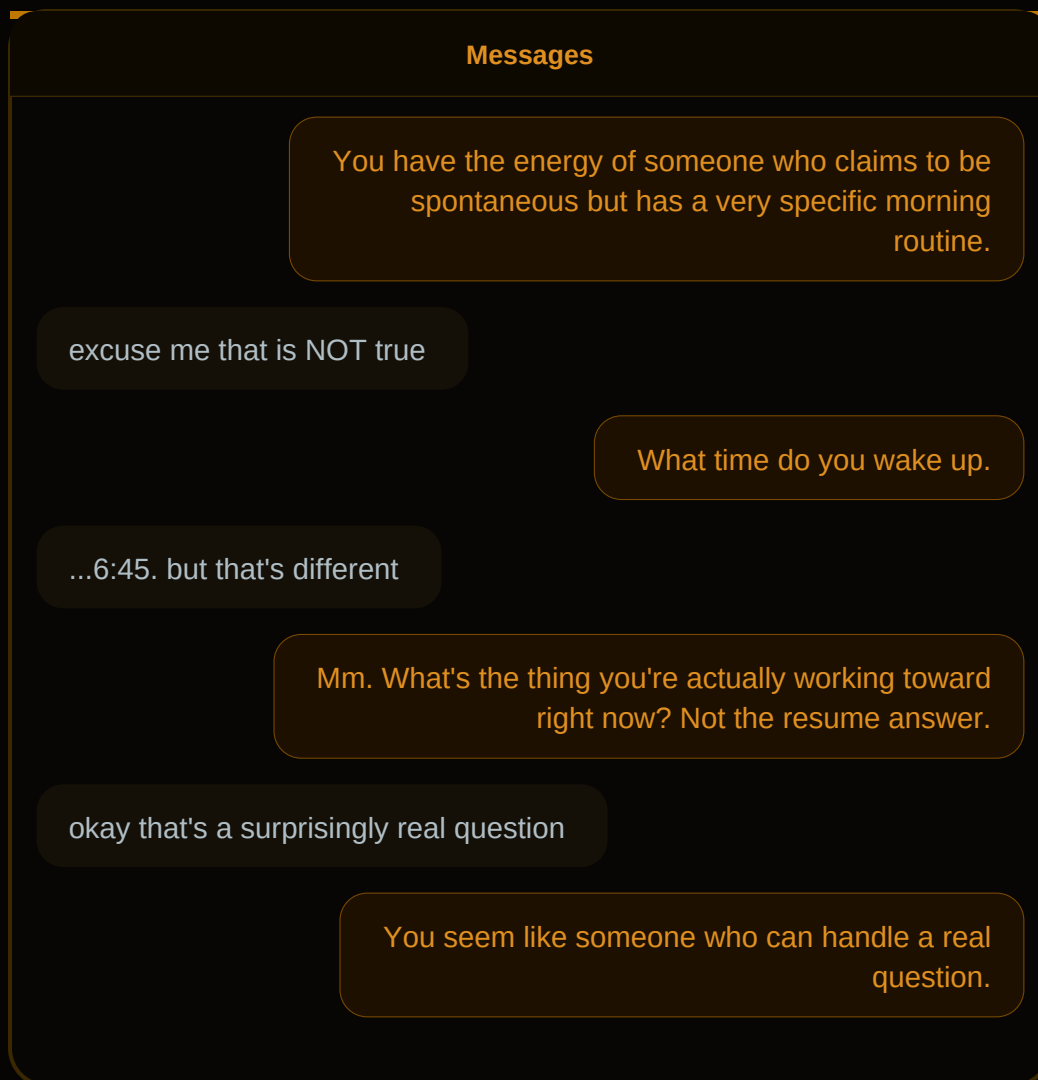
THE SHORT KING SERIES

BOOK SIX

The Attraction Conversation

How to Make Her Feel Something Every Time You Talk

TEASE Friction that creates chemistry	›	QUALIFY Make her earn your attention	›	TENSION What is left unsaid	›	STORY Pull her into your world	›	RAPPORT Make her feel understood
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The Verbal Attraction System That Turns Good Conversations Into Real Chemistry.

The Short King Coaching

WHO THIS IS FOR

"Most men can hold a conversation. Very few can hold one that makes a woman feel something. That gap is what this book closes."

This book is for the man who is genuinely good at talking but can't seem to make the leap from interesting to attractive. The one whose conversations are smooth and enjoyable but somehow stay

in friendly territory no matter how much time passes. The one who leaves interactions thinking it went well and then wonders why nothing follows.

The difference between a conversation that builds attraction and one that builds nothing isn't intelligence, looks, or height. It's a specific set of verbal behaviors that shift the emotional register of an interaction from neutral to charged. All of it is learnable. All of it is in this book.

How This Book Connects

The tools in this book apply everywhere: in-person approaches from Book Five, first dates from Book Two, and text exchanges from Book One. Think of this as the verbal engine that runs underneath all of those contexts. The frameworks work in any conversation where you want to move someone from neutral to genuinely interested.

INTRODUCTION

Talking Is Not the Same as Attracting

There is a man you've met, probably more than once, who is shorter than average and does not seem to care. Women around him are engaged and laughing. He is not the tallest man there. He may not be the best-looking. But something about the way he talks makes him the most interesting person in the space.

That man is not special. He has a skill set. A specific set of conversational behaviors that create emotional variety, pull people into his frame, and make every interaction feel like it has stakes and texture. He probably developed it through trial and error over years. This book gives you the architecture of that skill set directly so you can build it in weeks rather than years.

The emotional contagion effect, documented consistently in social psychology research, establishes that emotions are transferable between people in conversation. A man who moves through a conversation with genuine playfulness, curiosity, and occasional sharp tension transfers those states to the person he is talking to. She doesn't feel attracted to him because she decided to. **She feels it because the conversation produced it in her.**

"Attraction is not something you have or don't have. It is something a conversation creates or fails to create. You can learn to create it."

CHAPTER ONE

The Tease

Friction That Creates Chemistry

Teasing is the most misused and most powerful tool in the attraction conversation. When it lands correctly it creates a specific emotional state in her that nothing else produces: the feeling of being seen clearly enough to be challenged, by someone confident enough to challenge her. That combination is rare and it is magnetic.

When it goes wrong it reads as mean, insecure, or try-hard. The difference is entirely in the intent behind it and the calibration of it. Teasing from a place of genuine playfulness and warmth is completely different from teasing that is trying to lower someone's value to raise your own. She can feel the difference immediately.

The most effective form of teasing combines light confidence bordering on arrogance with genuine humor — so that the edge is softened and the whole thing reads as playful rather than cutting. The formula requires practice because most men either remove the edge entirely and produce something too soft to create chemistry, or they keep the edge and remove the warmth and produce something that stings.

The Five Tease Archetypes

THE ASSUMPTION TEASE

Make a slightly wrong playful assumption about her and state it with total confidence. She corrects you. You either hold it or graciously upgrade your assessment. The back-and-forth creates energy.

"You seem like someone who has very strong opinions about brunch and a very complicated relationship with punctuality."

"I can already tell you're the friend in your group who ends up apologizing for everyone else's behavior."

"You have the energy of someone who claims to be low-maintenance but has a very specific way they like their coffee."

THE CALLBACK TEASE

Reference something she said earlier and give it a slightly exaggerated or ironic treatment. Signals you were actually listening — rare — while showing you're comfortable enough to poke at what she said.

"You mentioned being spontaneous. I'm going to need more evidence before I accept that claim."

"Said by someone who definitely has a show they've watched three times and won't admit it."

THE REVERSAL

She says something and you agree in a way that flips the frame — recasting it so you're in an interesting light and inviting her to push back.

THE ALMOST-COMPLIMENT

You begin what sounds like a compliment and redirect it just before it lands. She leans in expecting the compliment and gets something more interesting instead.

THE MISINTERPRETATION

Take something she said and interpret it in a flirtatious direction, then let her correct you. The correction means she's now defending herself to you — she is invested in your perception of her.

Almost-Compliment Examples

→ "You're actually really easy to talk to. Which is suspicious."

→ "You're funnier than I expected. I'll admit that."

→ "For someone who claims not to care about [topic], you clearly care a lot about [topic]."

Calibration: Reading When to Tease and When to Pull Back

Teasing requires real-time calibration. Too early reads as presumptuous. Too frequent reads as insecure. Too rare and the conversation stays flat. One tease for every three exchanges is the right frequency in an early conversation. As comfort builds, frequency can increase.

✓ **CALIBRA
TED**

Genuine laughter or a playful push-back. Continue.

■ **READ**

One flat response. Data point. Adjust slightly. Don't overcorrect.

✗ **PULL
BACK**

Two flat responses in a row. Pull back. Rebuild warmth before trying again.

The Tease Works in Text Too

Every archetype from this chapter translates directly into your text game from Book One:

Messages

You have the energy of someone who claims to hate drama but is somehow always in the middle of it.

excuse me WHAT

Prove me wrong.

I am literally the most low drama person

The most low drama people never have to announce it.

okay you're annoying

There it is.

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE MAN WHO COULDN'T TEASE

A client described himself as incapable of teasing because he was always afraid of offending someone. His conversations were warm and pleasant and attracted zero romantic interest. We broke the tease down to its simplest form: the assumption tease only, for two weeks, with anyone regardless of context — baristas, colleagues, friends — before attempting it in a dating context. By week two he had a date tell him she loved how he talked to her because he didn't treat her like she was fragile. That observation captured exactly what the tease produces when it lands: the feeling of being engaged with as a full person rather than handled carefully. He hadn't become fearless. He had become practiced.

■ YOUR MOVE

Use the assumption tease in five different conversations this week. Not all with women you're attracted to — with colleagues, friends, anyone. The goal is low-stakes reps until the delivery feels natural. Track responses: a genuine laugh or playful pushback means it landed. Collect five of those before moving to higher-stakes contexts.

CHAPTER TWO

Qualification

Making Her Earn Your Attention

Qualification is the most counterintuitive tool in the attraction conversation because it runs against every instinct most men have in a dating context. The instinct is to impress, to demonstrate value, to show her why she should choose you. Qualification flips this entirely: you make her demonstrate value to you.

The psychological principle: effort justification, documented by Elliot Aronson in decades of social psychology research — people value things more when they've worked for them. A man who is easy to impress signals that his attention comes at no cost. And as with any resource available at no cost, it gets treated as having no value.

The man who qualifies signals, through specific verbal behaviors, that he has standards she hasn't yet met — that his attention and interest are contingent on her being genuinely interesting, not just present. That signal is experienced as attractive regardless of height, looks, or social status because it accurately reflects the internal state of a man who has genuine options.

Qualifying Questions

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

"Most people in [context] are pretty predictable. What makes you different from the standard version of that?"

"What's something you're genuinely good at that most people don't know about you?"

"I can tell you have opinions about things. What's one you'd actually defend in an argument?"

"Beyond the job and the city and all of that stuff — what actually drives you right now?"

Qualifying Responses

The response version is subtler and more powerful. After she says something, you evaluate it before responding. Not harshly — just with the energy of someone who is genuinely assessing whether this clears the bar.

QUALIFYING RESPONSES — HOW TO EVALUATE BEFORE APPROVING

INTERESTING ANSWER

SHE: shares an interesting opinion or story

YOU: "Okay. I'll give you that. That's actually a good answer."

SAFE ANSWER

SHE: says something predictable

YOU: "That's the safe answer. What do you actually think?"

SURPRISE

SHE: says something genuinely surprising

YOU: "I wasn't expecting that. Now I'm curious."

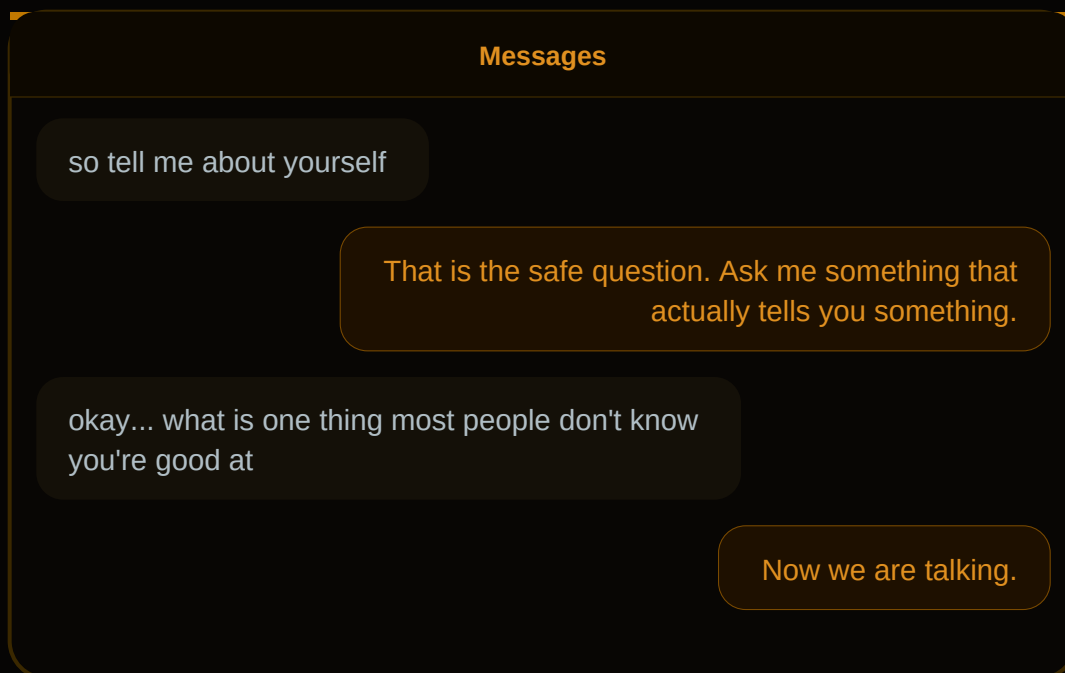
SOMETHING REAL

SHE: shares an achievement or passion

YOU: "That's interesting. Tell me more about that part specifically."

Qualification in Text Conversations

The same frame that works in person transfers directly to text exchanges:



The Frame Flip

Standard dating conversation: he pursues, she evaluates. Qualification flips this: he evaluates, she pursues. This is not manipulation. It is operating from the internal state of a man who genuinely knows his own worth and is finding out whether she's compatible with it.

The flip is maintained through consistency. If you qualify her for three minutes and then collapse into obvious approval-seeking for the next ten, the frame resets. The internal state has to be real: you are genuinely curious about whether this person is someone you want to spend more time with.

◆ CASE STUDY: COMPOSITE — THE FRAME FLIP IN ACTION

Two men on first dates the same week. The first spent the evening telling her about himself — his job, his accomplishments, his travels — occasionally asking questions but always pivoting back to his own demonstrations of value. She was polite throughout and didn't respond to his follow-up text. The second asked three genuine qualifying questions over the course of the evening and responded to her answers with either honest approval or a gentle challenge. She described the date to her friend afterward as the first time in a long time she'd felt like she was actually talking to someone who was interested in whether she was interesting rather than whether she was interested in him. She texted him first the following morning.

■ YOUR MOVE

In your next conversation with someone you're attracted to, ask at least two qualifying questions and use the evaluating response on at least one thing she says. The frame flip feels uncomfortable at first because it's unfamiliar. Do it anyway and note what changes in the energy of the conversation.

CHAPTER THREE

Tension and What Is Left Unsaid

The Space Between the Words

Tension is the most misunderstood element of attraction conversations because most people confuse it with awkwardness. They are not the same thing. Awkward silence is the absence of something to say. Charged silence is the presence of something that doesn't need to be said. The first feels like failure. The second feels like chemistry.

The ability to create and sustain conversational tension is what separates men who are good company from men who make women think about them afterward. Arousal transfer theory shows that physiological arousal generated in one context gets associated with whatever is most salient in the environment at the time. In a charged conversation, that salient element is you.

The Four Tension Tools

THE UNFINISHED SENTENCE

Begin a thought and let it trail off rather than completing it. She fills the gap mentally and the filling creates investment. The brain hates open loops. An unfinished sentence creates one.

""There's something about the way you said that that makes me think..." [hold eye contact, let her ask]"

""You know what, never mind." [she will ask. wait for it.]"

""I was going to say something but I think I'll hold that one for now.""

THE IMPLICATION

Say something that implies more than it states. What the brain fills in feels more personal and more charged than anything you could have said directly.

""I have a feeling you're a lot more interesting than you're letting on right now.""

""We'd probably get into trouble together.""

""I'm going to resist saying what I'm actually thinking right now.""

""I can already tell this conversation is going to go somewhere different.""

THE DELIBERATE PAUSE

Before responding to something she said, hold the pause one full beat longer than conversationally necessary. Look at her during the pause. Communicates genuine consideration while creating stillness that feels charged rather than empty.

THE PUSH-PULL RHYTHM

Warmth followed by slight withdrawal. Interest followed by independence. The alternation creates variable reward dynamics: she can't quite predict what comes next, which keeps her engaged in ways that consistent warmth or consistent distance never could.

What Not to Do

EXPLAINING THE MOMENT

When something charged happens between you, the anxious instinct is to acknowledge it or make it comfortable. Don't. The charged moment is valuable precisely because it is unspoken. The moment you name it you dissolve it.

FILLING EVERY SILENCE

Comfortable people can share silence. Anxious men fill every gap because silence feels like evidence of failure. Practice letting silences land for two full beats before speaking. The silence is not empty. It is the space where the chemistry lives.

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE SILENCE

A client asked me why his dates were consistently described as fun but not chemistry. He was a genuinely good conversationalist who talked constantly and smoothly with no gaps. When I described charged silence he looked genuinely skeptical. He'd been trained by his own anxiety that silence meant something was wrong and had spent years eliminating it from every conversation. We ran a deliberate practice: in his next conversation he had to let every pause breathe for two full seconds before responding. He texted me after the date with one sentence: 'I didn't say much in the last twenty minutes and she kissed me in the parking lot.' The silence he'd been afraid of was the thing she'd been waiting for.

■ YOUR MOVE

In your next conversation, deploy one unfinished sentence and let it hang. Watch what she does with the open loop. Then at some point in the same conversation, hold a silence for two full seconds before responding. That discomfort you feel is the tension she is experiencing as attraction.

CHAPTER FOUR

Storytelling as Attraction

Pulling Her Into Your World

Stories are the most powerful connection tool in the attraction conversation because they operate on two levels simultaneously: the surface level of the narrative and the deeper level of what the narrative reveals about who you are. A well-told story does more to communicate your character, your humor, your values, and your emotional depth than any amount of direct self-description ever could.

Narrative transportation theory shows that when people are absorbed in a well-told story their critical faculties lower and their emotional engagement increases. They are inside the experience rather than evaluating it from the outside. **For shorter men this is especially high-leverage. Stories are entirely independent of height.** A man who tells a compelling story with the right structure is one of the most attractive things a person can experience in conversation. No physical variable competes with it.

The Three-Act Story Structure

ACT ONE: SETUP

Who, what, where. Two to three sentences maximum. The setup is not the story — it is just enough context for the story to make sense. Most men spend too long here and lose her before anything interesting happens.

ACT TWO: THE TENSION

Something goes wrong, unexpected, or becomes a decision point. This creates stakes. Without tension in act two there is no story — there is only an anecdote. The tension does not have to be dramatic. Small and specific tension is often more compelling than large and vague tension because it is more relatable.

ACT THREE: RESOLUTION + POINT

What happened and what it reveals. The resolution answers the immediate question. The point — often unspoken — is what the story tells her about who you are. The best attraction stories have a point that is implied rather than stated. She draws the conclusion herself, which makes it feel true rather than performed.

Story Structure in Practice

STORY STRUCTURE EXAMPLE

SETUP (2 sentences)

"I was in Tokyo last year, first time, completely alone."

TENSION (the interesting part)

"Missed my train, phone dead, no Japanese, wrong neighborhood, and I'd told nobody where I was going."

RESOLUTION + POINT

"Ended up spending four hours with a couple who didn't speak English, sharing food I couldn't name, having one of the best nights of the trip. Some of the best things happen when the plan completely falls apart."

[Implied: I'm curious, adaptable, I lean into chaos. I travel alone confidently.]

Mini-Stories for Approaches and Text

Not every context allows for a full three-act story. In an approach or a text exchange you have two to four sentences before you lose momentum. The mini-story follows the same structure but compressed: one sentence of setup, one sentence of tension or twist, one sentence of resolution that implies something interesting about you.

MINI-STORY EXAMPLES

"I tried to cook something impressive for a date once. The fire alarm went off twice and she ended up ordering pizza. She still talks about it as her favorite date."

[Reveals: self-aware, can laugh at himself, the date liked him anyway]

"I got lost in a city I'd lived in for two years last month. Ended up in a neighborhood I'd never been to. Best coffee I've found in this city is there."

[Reveals: observant, curious, doesn't take himself too seriously]

◆ CASE STUDY: COMPOSITE — FINDING THE TENSION IN STORIES YOU ALREADY HAVE

A client who described himself as a boring storyteller recorded two of his date conversations. Listening back, the issue was clear: he described events without tension. His stories had setups and resolutions but no act two. Everything that happened was fine and then it resolved fine. No stakes. We spent two weeks finding the tension in stories he already had — the moment the plan changed, the thing that went wrong, the decision that wasn't obvious. He didn't find new stories. He found the interesting parts of the ones he already had. On his next three dates he used the restructured versions. Two of the three women asked follow-up questions that extended the conversation by ten minutes each. The stories were the same experiences. The architecture changed everything.

■ YOUR MOVE

Write down three stories from your own life right now. For each one, identify: where is the tension in act two? If there is no tension, find the moment the plan changed or something unexpected happened. Restructure the story around that moment. Then tell each one out loud to yourself before using it in a real conversation.

CHAPTER FIVE

Deep Rapport

Making Her Feel Understood

Everything covered so far — teasing, qualification, tension, storytelling — operates in the space of attraction. This chapter operates in a different space: connection. And connection is what turns attraction into something she wants to pursue beyond the current interaction.

Carl Rogers identified unconditional positive regard and genuine empathic understanding as the two most powerful relational forces available between two people. When a person feels genuinely seen and understood rather than evaluated, they experience a depth of connection that is rare enough to be remembered long after the interaction ends.

Deep rapport is the point in a conversation where she stops performing and starts talking. Where the social guard drops and something real comes through. Most men never create this because they are either too busy demonstrating their own value or too busy asking questions to actually listen to the answers.

The Active Listening System

REFLECT THE MEANING

When she says something, respond to what it means rather than just what it says.

She says she's been thinking about changing careers → You say: 'It sounds like you've outgrown something. Is that what it feels like?' — You heard the feeling, not just the information.

GO ONE LAYER DEEPER

After she answers a question, follow up one layer deeper rather than pivoting to a new topic.

Surface: what do you do? → One layer: what's the part of it you actually care about? → Two layers: what would it look like if that part was everything?

**NAME WHAT
SHE'S
DESCRIBING**

When she describes a feeling or experience, naming it accurately — without her having used the word herself — creates a moment of genuine recognition that feels deeply connecting.

"That feels like this." — "Yes. Exactly." — That moment of being accurately named is one of the most connecting things one person can do for another.

Deep Rapport in Practice: Weak vs. Strong

WEAK VS STRONG RESPONSES

SHE: "I've been really stressed lately. Work is just a lot."

✗ **WEAK:** "What's going on at work?" — information-gathering, surface level

✓ **STRONG:** "It sounds like you're running on empty. What's actually getting to you about it?" — meaning-seeking

SHE: "I used to be really close with my family and now I barely see them."

✗ **WEAK:** "That's too bad. How far away do they live?" — misses the feeling entirely

✓ **STRONG:** "That's a specific kind of loss, isn't it? The people are still there but something changed." — names what she's describing

SHE: "I've been thinking about traveling more but I never actually go."

✗ **WEAK:** "Where would you want to go?" — pivots to information instead of depth

✓ **STRONG:** "What's the thing that keeps stopping you? Not the practical stuff. The real reason." — goes one layer deeper

When to Use Rapport vs Tension

The most sophisticated attraction conversations move between tension tools and rapport tools deliberately. Too much tension without rapport and the interaction feels like a game she's not sure she wants to play. Too much rapport without tension and she experiences you as a close friend rather than a potential partner.

FIRST THIRD

Tease & qualify.
Build energy. Lower
the guard.



MIDDLE THIRD

Tension. Slow the
pace. Push-pull. Let
silences breathe.



FINAL THIRD

Rapport. Go deeper.
Make her feel
understood.

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE REORDER

A client came to me convinced he was too emotionally available to be attractive. His dates consistently ended with women telling him he was a great guy and then not pursuing things further. When we looked at his conversational patterns the problem wasn't that he was emotionally available. It was that he went deep in the first ten minutes with no tension built first. The rapport arrived before she had any reason to find it compelling. We reordered his approach: tease and qualification for the first 30 minutes, then one genuine depth question. On his next date he held the tease energy for the first 40 minutes and then asked a single deep question late in the evening. She answered it for 15 minutes without him saying much at all. She told him at the end of the night that it was the most interesting conversation she'd had in years. He'd asked less and created more by reordering when he deployed each tool.

■ YOUR MOVE

In your next conversation, consciously run the tools in sequence: tease in the first third, qualification in the middle third, one deep rapport question in the final third. Notice how the emotional register of the conversation shifts in each phase. Write down which tool felt most natural and which felt most uncomfortable — the uncomfortable one is the one you need the most practice with.

Quick Reference

Screenshot this. Review it before dates, approaches, and important conversations.

FIRST THIRD Tease + Qualify	➤	MIDDLE THIRD Tension + Push-Pull	➤	FINAL THIRD Rapport + Depth
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THE FIVE TOOLS

- 1 **Tease:** First third. One per three exchanges. Playful intent always.
- 2 **Qualify:** Middle. Questions that invite her to earn your interest.
- 3 **Tension:** Throughout. Unfinished sentences, pauses, implications.
- 4 **Story:** Any point. Setup brief. Tension in act two. Point implied.
- 5 **Rapport:** Final third. Reflect meaning. Go one layer deeper.

TEASE CALIBRATION

- ✓ Genuine laugh or playful pushback = calibrated. Continue.
- One flat response = data point. Adjust slightly.
- ✗ Two flat responses = pull back. Rebuild warmth first.

STORY STRUCTURE CHECKLIST

- Setup: 2–3 sentences maximum
- Tension in act two: what went wrong, changed, or became a decision
- Resolution that implies something about you without stating it
- At least two emotional registers: humor + genuine, or tension + warmth

DEEP RAPPORT QUICK MOVES

- **Reflect meaning:** Respond to what she means, not just what she said.
- **Go deeper:** After she answers, follow up one layer below the surface.
- **Name the feeling:** Identify the emotion before she uses the word.
- **Match depth:** Share something real at the same level she is sharing.

TENSION RULES

- Do not fill charged silences. Let them breathe.
- Do not explain the moment. Naming it dissolves it.
- Push-pull: warmth then slight withdrawal. Keep her uncertain.

The conversation is handled. Now let's fix how she finds you in the first place.

You have the full verbal system now. Every tool you need to make a conversation feel like chemistry, build genuine connection, and leave her thinking about you hours after it ends.

The last piece of the Short King puzzle is the one that runs in the background of everything: your dating profile. While you are getting better in person, she is still encountering you first as a photograph and a few lines of text. And for shorter men, the dating app environment is where height filtering is most aggressive and where the gap between men who know what they're doing and men who don't is widest.

Swipe Right on Yourself: The Short King's Complete Dating Profile Overhaul

Book Seven in the Short King Series

- The psychology of how women actually swipe and what triggers a yes
 - The photography system that frames a shorter man's appearance optimally
 - The height disclosure strategy that disarms the objection before it becomes one
 - The bio and prompt system that makes her curious before she's even matched
-



*"The best conversation you'll ever have starts with opening your mouth.
You know how to do that now."*

THE SHORT KING COMPLETE SYSTEM

Seven books covering every dimension of the dating game for shorter men: texting, first dates, confidence, presence, approach, attraction conversations, and dating profiles. Each works as a standalone. Together they are the complete operating system.

Want direct coaching?

Coaching gives you someone watching your real conversations, identifying exactly where the verbal tools are breaking down, and accelerating your results with direct feedback on what is actually happening. Reach out through the Short King Coaching platform.



Make her feel something. That's the whole job.